

O wizeden eyes resplendent

In memory of Robert Coon (1931 - 2021)

Text: Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

Music: Gustav Holst, 1921

THAXTED 13.13.14.12.13.14

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at the beginning of each measure. The lyrics are written in three parts (1, 2, 3) below the staff, with some words hyphenated across lines. The score is divided into six systems, each with a new line of music and lyrics.

1 O wizeden eyes resplendent, we seek the things you saw,
2 O eager lips of blessing, speak grace for us to-day,
3 O trembling hands of service, wrap arms around us all.

that urged you to such greatness, and humbled you in awe.
for-give us and our mourning, our stubborn, petty ways.
Take respite from your labors, and joy in heaven's call.

We strive now, as you once strove, toward the beacon, toward the Light.
We speak now, as you once spoke, prayers and stories, holy jest,
We fight now, as you once fought, not with sword, but plow-share hewn.

With forebears inviting, it beckons yet more bright.
to bolster worn hearts and inspire us to our best.
Through clangorous war drums you hummed a different tune:

Though tearful eyes may hinder, and sorrow shroud our way,
You uttered blessed assurance, through strife, your words did calm,
Ev'ry note is one of justice, each tear can shatter chains,

what seems to us like evening may just be break of day.
there is a far in Gilead, vouchsafed for us a Balm.
ev'ry sigh becomes a rush of wind, set free across the plains.